Pratik Praveen Mehta

Supply Chain Manager | Strategic Sourcing, Supplier Management, Inventory & Lifecycle Planning

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Supply chain manager with 12+ years across the automotive aftermarket, supply chain consulting, and manufacturing. Leads sourcing, supplier management, inventory, and lifecycle strategy for a private-label division with $120M in revenue and $60M+ in annual spend. Negotiates supplier contracts through signature, runs RFI/RFQ/RFP processes and total cost of ownership analysis, and manages contract manufacturers and supplier quality. Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M in spend, freed $15M+ in working capital, and built a forecasting engine that lifted forecast accuracy from 53% to 74%. Owns the roadmap for a catalog platform serving 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers. Leads 4 direct and 3 indirect reports and briefs executives up to the CFO and CEO. B.E. Electrical Engineering and MBA; Lean Six Sigma Green Belt.

CORE SKILLS

Sourcing & Supplier Management: Strategic Sourcing, RFI/RFQ/RFP, Contract Negotiation, Total Cost of Ownership, Tooling & NRE, Contract Manufacturers, AVL Qualification, Corrective Action Plans, Supplier Performance, Cost Reduction

Inventory, Planning & Lifecycle: Inventory Optimization, End-of-Life & Excess Inventory, Demand Forecasting (Statistical & ML), New Product Introduction, Product Supersession, Spare Parts & Refurbishment, S&OP Support

Data, Analytics & Systems: SQL, Python, Tableau, Power BI, SAP IBP, SAP Procurement, Kinaxis, Custom ERP, Advanced Excel, AI Agent Development

Leadership & Process: Cross-Functional Leadership, Team Management, Executive Communication, Lean Six Sigma, Catalog & Product Data, Roadmap Ownership, Jira

AI AGENTS CONFIGURED AT LKQ CORPORATION

- **Competitor Price Tracking Agent:** monitors competitor and market pricing for private-label products to support pricing and sourcing decisions.
- **Marketing Asset Creation Agent:** generates marketing assets for private-label brands.
- **Forecast Accuracy & Insights Agent:** surfaces forecast accuracy results and insights for planning teams.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Business Process Specialist — Supply Chain Strategy & Operations — LKQ Corporation **May 2023 – Present**

San Jose, CA

- Lead sourcing and supplier management for a private-label division with $120M in revenue and $60M+ in annual spend, working with suppliers and contract manufacturers; run RFI/RFQ/RFP processes and TCO models and negotiate contracts through signature, including tooling and non-recurring engineering (NRE) terms.
- Secured a 2% cost reduction on $25M in spend through supplier cost-sharing and tooling and NRE negotiation.
- Freed $15M+ in working capital by redesigning end-of-life and excess & obsolete inventory strategy and governance.
- Escalation point for supplier quality and delivery issues through Critical Action Plans; manage Approved Vendor List (AVL) qualification and supplier performance.
- Lead new product introduction (NPI), product supersession, and lifecycle decisions for private-label parts, using lifecycle analytics to decide SKU introduction, continuation, and end-of-life; coordinate spare parts, refurbishment, and warranty returns.
- Identified gaps that became new internal products: an ML-based forecasting program, a new product tool, and dynamic min-max inventory logic, each taken from idea through design, build, and adoption.
- Apply statistical and ML forecasting to demand and supply planning, using retail channel data such as EDI and POS to improve availability and inventory decisions.
- Ran A/B tests on promotions, price elasticity, and new product launch strategies for private-label brands.
- Own the roadmap for a catalog management portal used by 30,000+ customers and 120+ suppliers, writing PRDs and working with engineers through release and UAT; reached a 92% data completeness score, with brands recognized at SEMA Gold level for data quality.
- Bridge senior leaders (VP Category Management, VP IT, SVP, CFO, CEO) and technical teams, turning business needs into requirements for analytics tools and AI agents; brief them on supplier performance, cost, and supply risk using Tableau and Power BI dashboards across 15 private-label brands.

- Lead 4 direct and 3 indirect reports with a formal intake, prioritization, and delivery governance process.

Inventory Process Specialist — Supply Chain Optimization — LKQ Corporation **Oct 2021 – Mar 2023**
Bengaluru, India

- Built a Python- and SQL-driven forecasting engine across 6,000+ SKUs using statistical and ML-based methods, lifting rolling 52-week forecast accuracy from 53% to 74%.
- Built a scenario simulation platform to model supply and demand risk and bottlenecks in real time, giving leadership early visibility before issues reached operations.
- Led a Tableau BI transformation that automated manual reporting, cutting turnaround time by 70% and raising adoption across 20+ FTEs.
- Led and developed 4 direct and 3 indirect reports (Business Analysts), owning dashboards, MIS reporting, and SQL data warehousing.

Senior Consultant — Supply Chain Analytics & Transformation — Bristlecone Ltd. **Jun 2019 – Sep 2021**
Bengaluru, India

- Led a 5-member cross-functional team to build Rapid Insights 360, a supply chain analytics tool built on SAP Analytics Cloud (SAC) with sub-products Spend 360, Inventory Management 360, Asset Management 360, and FSCA 360, taking it from prototype through introduction to commercial offerings on the SAP App Center, and laying the foundation for a new Analytics & AI Practice Center of Excellence.
- Architected the product on a data warehouse layer so it ran on SAP and Oracle ERP and stayed compatible with other ERP and data systems; separated reusable core capabilities from client-specific configuration.
- Built reusable accelerators, frameworks, and dashboards in Power BI, Tableau, Qlik Sense, Sisense, and SAP SAC, used by pre-sales teams, deployed on the SAP App Center, and shared with customers.
- Ran pre-sales and product demonstrations for 18–20 prospects across CPG, semiconductor, healthcare, financial services, and energy; tracked the pipeline in Salesforce.
- Presented to CPOs, CTOs, SVPs, and VPs at Fortune 500 accounts and led 3+ end-to-end engagements ($500K–$2M in deal value) from proposals through delivery and hypercare.
- Built ML forecasting models with PyCaret; advised on SAP IBP, Kinaxis, and SAP procurement implementations and supported a material and BoM readiness engagement for an enterprise hardware client.

Front Lead Engineer — Ultratech Cements — Aditya Birla Group **Sep 2015 – Apr 2018**
Multiple Locations, India

- Built SAP-based MIS dashboards that helped reduce working capital in slow-moving assets by 28%; led a Lean Six Sigma DMAIC project saving INR 1.5 Cr annually and cutting energy use by 1.3 kWh/ton.

Software Engineer — Tech Mahindra **Jun 2014 – Sep 2015**
Pune, India

- Owned end-to-end delivery of a reporting dashboard for a US telecom client, from development through client-facing support.

EDUCATION

Great Lakes Institute of Management, Chennai, India — Post Graduate Program (MBA), Marketing
Government College of Engineering, Chandrapur (R.T.M. Nagpur University), India — Bachelor of Engineering, Electrical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Lean Six Sigma Green Belt; Certified Supply Chain Professional (CSCP) — in progress
- “Best Kaizen” award (twice) and “Most Valuable Member” award, LKQ Corporation
- “Beautiful Mind” and “Core Values in Action” awards, Bristlecone